Spotted Website: Build Guide

spotted.ae · step by step, like you're 5 · 30 Oct 2026 · You don't write code: you paste prompts into Claude Code

Good news: your website is already started on GitHub (**Spotted-website**). It has a scroll story, a waitlist, a WhatsApp button and a menu. We build on top of it.

Rule break found: the current story uses a **faceless woman in a headscarf**. Your rule is **no human figures or features at all**. Step 2 replaces her with objects (pin, phone, road, café).

What you're building (the map)

Page	What it shows	At launch
Landing	Holographic red cloth banner flies in from the top-left, lands in the centre, and visitors can grab it. It says "COMING SOON · 01.01.2027". "Spotted" rises under it.	ON
What's Spotted (home)	Why Spotted exists, how it helps people, "never miss out on fun"	ON
Restaurants / **Shops**	Holographic "Coming soon" cloth + waitlist. Hidden behind it: video carousel, List/Grid flip cards, place pages	Cloth ON, the rest OFF
Influencers	What creators get (stars, Creator Pro AED 249) + waitlist	ON
Careers · **About**	Simple pages	ON
Sign up / Log in	Users: make an account → "Get the app". Partners: log in → dashboard	Sign-up ON, dashboards OFF
Dashboards	Restaurant/shop + influencer, with labelled example data	Built, OFF (demo link only)
Privacy · **Terms**	Needed by the app stores	ON

"ON/OFF" = one file (**src/config/features.ts**) with true/false switches. Later you just say *"switch on the restaurants carousel"*.

Free tools you need (no laptop power used)

Tool	Like you're 5	Where	Cost
Claude Code (web)	Your builder. You talk, it builds.	claude.ai/code	Your plan
GitHub	The box that keeps your files	github.com (you have it)	Free
Vercel	Puts the site on the internet	vercel.com	Free
Supabase	Remembers accounts and numbers	supabase.com	Free

.ae registrar	Sells you "spotted.ae"	any accredited .ae registrar	**The only cost**
Zoho Mail	Gives you sarah@spotted.ae	zoho.com/mail	Free plan

How to work (every step)

1. Go to **claude.ai/code** and choose the repository **Spotted-website**.
2. Paste **one prompt**. Wait until it says done.
3. Open the **preview link** it gives you, on your phone too.
4. Something's wrong? Say it in plain words, e.g. *"the banner falls too fast"*, or attach a screenshot.
5. Looks right? Say **"commit this step"**. Then move on to the next step. **Don't skip ahead.**

Step 0 · Let Claude Code learn the rules (no code yet)

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Read the whole project first. Do not write code yet. Then create a file called SITE_RULES.md with these rules, and follow them in every future step:
- Brand colours only: purple #6A1FB0, deep purple #3C096C, red #E5383B, lilac #C9A2FF, yellow #FFD23F (highlights only), white; green #2BB673 only for green stars/growth; WhatsApp green #25D366 only on the WhatsApp button. Black only for small text.
- Font: Poppins only (500, 700, 800).
- Never draw people, faces, eyes, hands or any human figure. Use pins, phones, roads, cafes, plates, bags, stars.
- No real Instagram/TikTok logos; use generic icons.
- Light and dark theme on every page.
- Mobile first. Every animation needs a still fallback for slow phones and for Reduce Motion.
- Every big section can be switched on/off from src/config/features.ts.
Reply with a short list of what the site has now and what you will change.

Step 1 · Colours, light/dark theme and the pull-string lamp

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Set up the theme with the brand colours for light and dark mode, saved in the browser so it's remembered. Default: dark.
Add the theme switch as a pull-string lamp: a thin string hangs from the top-right with a small round handle.
- Hover over the string: a light bulb slides down into the centre of the screen.
- Stop hovering: the bulb slides back up and hides.
- Click the string: it stretches down a little and springs back like a real pull-cord, the bulb flashes, and the theme switches (light on = light theme, off = dark).
- On phones (no hover): tap the string = switch. The bulb shows briefly, then hides.
- Make it keyboard-accessible with a label "Switch light/dark". With Reduce Motion: no swinging, just switch.
Create src/config/features.ts with on/off switches for every section we add from now on.

Step 2 · Remove the human figure

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The current story illustrations include a faceless woman. Replace every human figure with objects only: a glowing pin moving along the road, a phone showing a reel, a cafe, bookmarks, stars. Keep the story words. No people anywhere on the site.

Step 3 · Landing: the holographic cloth

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Make a new landing section at the very top, full screen:
- Background: blurred, softly moving purple gradient (#3C096C to #6A1FB0) with lilac #C9A2FF light glows.
- A 3D cloth banner (Three.js cloth simulation) shaped like the Spotted red bookmark (red #E5383B, V-notch at the bottom, white location pin). Give it a shiny holographic sheen in purple/lilac/red tones.
- On load: the banner flies in from the top-left corner and lands in the centre with a soft sway. Then "Spotted" rises under it in Poppins 800, white.
- Printed on the cloth: "COMING SOON" and "01.01.2027". Put this text in features.ts so after launch it can say "OUT NOW" with App Store and Google Play buttons.
- Visitors can grab and drag the cloth with the mouse or finger, and it moves and settles like real fabric.
- Slow phone or Reduce Motion: show a still image of the banner instead.
- As the visitor scrolls down, a top bar fades in: logo left; links What's Spotted, Restaurants, Shops, Influencers, Careers, About; Sign up / Log in on the right; the lamp string top-right. On phones the links go into a menu button (three lines).

Design the artwork ourselves. Do not copy any other studio's design.

✓ The banner flies in, you can drag it, "Spotted" appears, and the top bar shows when you scroll.

Step 4 · What's Spotted page (the main page)

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Under the landing, build the "What's Spotted" page. Short, friendly sections with big Poppins headlines and one simple animation each (objects only):
1. Why we made it: "You save places from reels... and forget them."
2. How it works in 3 steps: See it in a reel → Save it to Spotted → Get a nudge when you're near (1, 5 or 10 km), even with the app closed.
3. Never miss out: Eat · Shop · Play, weekend plans, hidden gems, all in one place.
4. Made in the UAE, launching in Khalifa City, Abu Dhabi.
5. A waitlist / "Notify me" email box.

Only promise what the app really does at launch.

Step 5 · Restaurants and Shops pages

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Make /restaurants and /shops using ONE shared design (shops use the same parts).
Part A (ON now): the holographic cloth from Step 3, saying "COMING SOON · Restaurants" (or Shops), plus a short pitch and a "Join the waitlist" form (business name, type, area, email or WhatsApp number).
Part B (build it, but OFF in features.ts):
- Default view: a curved row of cards, each playing a 5-10 second muted video of the place's signature dish, with the place name and "Area, Emirate" (e.g. Khalifa City, Abu Dhabi). Only the centre video plays; the others show a still photo.
- Top of page: View options List | Grid, a Search button, and filter chips (Emirate, Category, Has offers).
- List/Grid: flash cards with dish photo, name, area. Hover (or tap on phones) flips the card: "Saved by 1.2K" (only when above 100), "2 offers" (count only), a "Spotted Partner" badge if paying, "View place".
- Place page: video, photos, location map + Directions, offer list, influencer reels about this place, "Open in Spotted app" button.
- Use labelled EXAMPLE data (3-4 places) until real partners join. Keep visit counts private (dashboard only).

Step 6 · Influencers, Careers, About

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Build three pages in the same style:
- /influencers: what creators get (yellow star = someone saved your reel's place, green star = they visited), Free vs Creator Pro (AED 249/month, 2 months free), example reel stats, and a creator waitlist (handles for Instagram, TikTok, YouTube).
- /careers: "We're not hiring yet. Leave your email for future roles." with a simple form.
- /about: the story of Spotted, made in the UAE, contact via WhatsApp and hello@spotted.ae.
Add /privacy (copy from the app's docs/PRIVACY_POLICY.md) and /terms.

Step 7 · Supabase (the memory box)

1. Go to **supabase.com**, sign up and click **New project**. Name it **spotted**, choose the region closest to the UAE, and save the password somewhere safe.
2. Go to **Project Settings → API**. Copy the **Project URL** and the **anon public key**.
3. Paste the prompt below. When Claude Code asks for the keys, put them in its **environment variables box**, **never in the chat text**.

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Connect Supabase. Create tables (with row-level security so each account only sees its own data) for: waitlist, user accounts, partner accounts (restaurant / shop / influencer), places, offers, media (videos, images, menu PDF, reel links), stars (yellow / purple / green, with date), pins, and reviews.
Sign up for normal users: name, email or phone/WhatsApp number, birthday (optional, for birthday treats), then a thank-you screen "Your account is ready. Use Spotted in the app" with store buttons (show "Coming 1 January" until launch).
Log in: email, phone or WhatsApp number + a one-time code (Supabase email code, free). Partners who log in go to their dashboard. A normal user who logs in sees "Spotted works in the app".
Add the Pins rule as a tested function: 1 Pin for every AED 15 of the bill; leftover money carries over to the next bill (AED 12 then AED 18 = AED 30 = 2 Pins, AED 0 left).

Step 8 · The dashboards (built now, switched OFF)

Look: dark glass cards over a **blurred purple night street / café** background (no person). Logos or initials instead of profile photos. A date picker for **Day · Week · Month** at the top. Every number shows labelled **EXAMPLE** data until real scans exist.

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Build the restaurant/shop dashboard at /dashboard/business with these cards:
1. Stars: yellow (saved, not visited), purple (visited, bought nothing), green (visited and bought) for today/this week/this month, each with % up or down vs last period and a line graph.
2. Customer journey bar: Saved → Reminded nearby → Visited → Bought.
3. Offers manager: add, edit, delete, pause offers; uses per offer; "best offer" (most customers); schedule offers to switch on at set hours (e.g. 3-5 pm weekdays).
4. Media manager: upload/replace/delete the signature-dish video (5-10 s), photos, menu PDF, reel links.
5. Top creators who brought guests, with the note "One guest can count for more than one creator."
6. Busiest times, repeat guests, stamp cards used, Pins and Spotted Select deals redeemed.
7. Real reviews (only from guests who scanned at the counter).
8. Branch switcher (multi-branch plans): each branch or all together.
9. Print your QR: download the counter QR as a JPG poster.
10. Preview: "See how customers see you".
11. Plan & billing: plan name, trial days left (2 months free), renew date, upgrade button.
12. Notifications: e.g. "Your offer ends tomorrow", "New creator reel about you".
13. Download this month's report as a PDF.
14. "Need help? Ask me anything": a text box; Send opens WhatsApp to +971508733160 with the message already typed (wa.me link, no AI).
Use clearly labelled example data. Hide the whole dashboard behind features.ts (OFF), with a /demo link I can show restaurants.

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Build the influencer dashboard at /dashboard/creator in the same style:
1. Stars: yellow (saves from their reels) and green (visits) for day/week/month with graph and % change.
2. Reels manager: add, edit, delete reel links, images and videos.
3. Per-reel stats: e.g. "Reel 1 Jan 2027 → 1,200 saves · 64 visits", ranked by saves.
4. Per-restaurant table: place, saves, visits, sales brought (AED).
5. Earnings, Spotted followers, Free vs Creator Pro (AED 249), "This month's top 7".
6. Plan & billing, notifications, PDF report, and the same "Ask me anything" WhatsApp box.
Free creators see the star and earnings cards locked with "Upgrade to Pro". Example data, OFF in features.ts, /demo link.

Step 9 · Put it online (Vercel)

1. Go to **vercel.com** and sign up with GitHub.
2. Click **Add New** → **Project**, choose **Spotted-website**, then click **Deploy**.
3. Go to **Settings** → **Environment Variables**, add the two Supabase keys, then **Redeploy**.
4. You get a free link like **spotted-website.vercel.app**. Use it to test, and as your privacy-policy link for the stores until the domain is ready.

Step 10 · Buy spotted.ae and connect it (only when the site is ready)

1. Search "**.ae domain registrar**". Pick an accredited one, then search **spotted.ae**. If it's taken, try getspotted.ae or spotted.app.
2. .ae names usually need an **Emirates ID or trade licence**. Have yours ready. Buy for 1 year and turn on **auto-renew**.
3. In Vercel go to **Settings → Domains → Add** and enter **spotted.ae** and **www.spotted.ae**. Vercel shows 1–2 "DNS records".
4. Log in to your registrar, open **DNS settings**, and copy those records in. Wait up to 24 hours. The padlock turns on by itself.

Step 11 · Your email (sarah@spotted.ae)

1. Sign up at **zoho.com/mail** (Forever Free plan) and add **spotted.ae**.
2. Zoho gives you **MX and TXT records**. Paste them into the same DNS settings at your registrar.
3. Create **sarah@**, **hello@** and **partners@spotted.ae**.

Step 12 · Final check before you tell anyone

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Check the site on a small phone, a big phone and a laptop, in light and dark mode. Make sure: the cloth works and has a still fallback, the lamp switches the theme, nothing hides behind the WhatsApp button, sign-up works, a restaurant can never see another restaurant's data, switched-off sections are really hidden, there are no people or faces anywhere, and pages load fast. Add page titles, descriptions and the Spotted icon as the favicon. Fix anything broken and list what you changed.

Then do it yourself: open the site on your phone, sign up with your own email, tap WhatsApp, and open the /demo dashboards.

Order of work (so you don't run out of time)

When	Do
Nov (weeks 1–2)	Steps 0–4: rules, lamp, cloth landing, What's Spotted. **App work comes first** if time is short.
Nov (weeks 3–4)	Steps 6, 9: Influencers/About/Careers/Privacy + go live on the free Vercel link
Dec	Step 5 (cloth part) + Step 7 sign-up + Step 10–11 domain and email
2027 onwards	Step 5 Part B + Step 8 dashboards (the /demo can be built earlier for pitching)

Honest check: the cloth + lamp + dashboards are a lot. The **app reaching the stores matters more** than a fancy website on 1 Jan. If December gets tight, launch with **landing + What's Spotted + Privacy** only. Everything else can wait, because it's switched off anyway.